

▼ GLASSHOUSE

JUDICIAL JABS

Judicial spats rarely spill out of the Supreme Court's storied chambers, the rare outage being the 2018 press conference when four judges revolted against then CJI Dipak Misra. But of late, the gloves seem to be off. First, a notice to former CJI **D.Y. Chandrachud** to vacate his official bungalow found its way to the media. Then, incumbent **CJI B.R. Gavai**, at a public event, took a swipe at his predecessor, saying he would move out the day he retired this November. Now, Gavai and his successor-designate, **Justice Surya Kant,** have publicly pulled up colleagues on the Bench, **Justices J.B. Pardiwala** and **R. Mahadevan**, for censuring an Allahabad High Court judge and directing that he be taken off the criminal roster, a move the duo later rolled back after protests from the HC.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ THE WAR THAT WASN'T

DARE DEVILRY

BJP MLA **Kantilal Amrutiya** of Morbi, Gujarat, and AAP's new legislator from Visavadar, **Gopal Italia,** have staged a drama fit for reality TV. After his June bypoll win, Italia boasted he could repeat the feat in Morbi. Amrutiya upped the ante with a Rs 2 crore dare. By mid-July, both parties were even challenging each other to resign, overlooking the fact that Italia wasn't yet sworn in and couldn't quit even if he wanted. On the appointed day, Amrutiya arrived in Gandhinagar with supporters; Italia was a no-show. Cue the twist: the duo was soon spotted having a friendly chat outside CM Bhupendra Patel's office, the photos of which went viral. A leaked audio then suggested that the whole spectacle was staged. The question on everyone's mind is: for what purpose?

